

Burning Steel — Rules (2026-08-05)

Title Page

<https://noltari13.github.io/burning-steel/>

[Introduction 3](#)

[General Rules 4](#)

[Key Terms 5](#)

[Area sizes 7](#)

[Line of sight 8](#)

[Measuring Distance 9](#)

[Playing the game 10](#)

[Deployment 11](#)

[Rounds, Turns, and orders. 11](#)

[Combat 12](#)

[Actions 13](#)

[Typical Attack Modifiers 16](#)

[Thresholds - Heat and HP 17](#)

[Terrain 19](#)

[Designing Matches, campaigns 21](#)

[Mech Stats 24](#)

[Mech Designer 26](#)

[Weapon Designer: 31](#)

[Missile Designer 35](#)

[Program Designer 37](#)

Introduction

Burning Steel is a tabletop mecha skirmish game. The mechs of Burning Steel are 10m to 15m tall, and can be represented with whatever miniatures you have.

These skirmishes take place over contested land, where there are important objectives to secure. It may involve picking up a crate of supplies, launching a civilian shuttle, or hacking into communication satellites. Certain groups may also be willing to pay extra for you to destroy an enemy mech, get attacked by the enemy, or find some hidden treasures across the map. The battle is rarely won by eliminating the opposing forces.

The flow of play is directed by short, two-actions turns with alternating activation. You are never sitting long waiting for your opponent, especially with off-turn reactions available.

To play the game, you will need a few models, 2-8 depending on how large your force is. A hex-map to play on, a handful of d10s, and some mech data sheets.

Additional accessories may be helpful, such as a straight-edge to measure line of sight, dry erase markers for writing on your sheets, terrain and structures.

General Rules

Read to the spirit of the rules, not the letter of the law.

Specific rules overwrite general rules. Equipment and actions may allow broad rules to be broken.

Rules are an agreement between players. If both players agree on how a rule or situation plays out, great. If not, have a brief discussion, if no resolution is made, high-roll to see which version is used.

If a rule is missed, like a persistent effect, do your best to roll-back to when the rule was broken. If any hidden information was revealed, do not roll-back past that point.

Always round up. Some effects may halve a value. $5 / 2 = 2.5$, counts as 3. If an effect states “for every 2, do X” then rounding should not be done.

Effects expire at the end of a turn, including multi-round effects, and conditional effects.

This game uses ten-sided dice (d10). 0, 00 is equal to 10.

Values are inclusive. Range 4 - 6 means that hexes that are 4, 5, 6 hexes away from the mech are in range. X+ means X or more.

Same named effects do not stack. Only apply the highest bonus.

Terrain effects have a height of 3 unless noted.

Key Terms

Unit: Mechs, structures, and odd units in-between.

Mech: The huge warmachines used to take objectives and attack foes.

Structures: Immovable buildings, walls, and other large terrain pieces. Structures will block line of sight, and may provide cover for units. Structures may be attacked and destroyed if they have a defense value.

Token: Small objects or special areas. Do not block movement, line of sight, or provide cover. Some tokens may be attacked and destroyed if they have a defense value.

Equipment: Items that are added to a mech, including kits, jets, packs, and so on.

Hit Points (HP): This describes the amount of damage a mech can take before being destroyed. When a mech reaches 0 HP, it is out of the game and removed from play. When a mech reaches $\frac{1}{2}$ HP and $\frac{1}{4}$ HP, it must roll on the threshold table. HP Threshold effects last until the match is over and the mech is restored.

Heat capacity (Hc): Heat is generated when the mech is pushed to its limits, or exposed to extremely high external temperatures. The base heat capacity for a mech is 10. If it exceeds its capacity (11+), it is now overheating. When it overheats, it must roll on the threshold table. Threshold effects caused by overheating only last until it is not overheating.

Defense Value (Dv): This is how hard it is to damage the mech. It is a combination of evasion through movement, additional armor, and obscuring through terrain. The baseline Dv for a mech is 3.

Movement (Mo): How fast the mech can move. This is the number of hexes it can move per turn. Moving faster provides evasion, increasing the Dv of the mech. Movement actions are marked with a “→”

Systems (S): The complexity and computational ability of a mech. Systems are used for equipping complex items, attacking and defending from harmful programs, and gaining access to computer systems.

Weight max (W): How much does the mech weigh, and how much equipment can the mech carry. Sometimes used when mechs collide.

Energy max (E): How much energy the mech's engine produces. Mainly used in mech construction for equipping high-energy items, or firing energy weapons.

Hardpoints (Ha): The areas where heavy offensive equipment is mounted. Weapon kits, Missile kits, and hacking kits. Up to 3 hardpoints may be used for one kit.

Damage: The amount of HP lost by a unit on a successful hit.

Optimal Range: The boundary of hexes a weapon is best suited to attack.

Range band: the full range a weapon can be used. It is the optimal range ± 2 hexes.

Shots: The number of hit attempts a weapon makes when used.

Accuracy: A constant bonus to the dice rolls of attacks.

Ammo: The number of times a piece of equipment can be used.

Duration: The number of rounds an effect will last.

Round: The span of time it takes for all mechs to be used.

Turn: A single mech's opportunity to act.

Action Point (AP): A resource mechs use to move and attack.

Order: Orders are used to give mechs turns.

Active player: The player who is able to play an order card.

Reacting player: The player that is not the active player, and can use mech reactions.

Area sizes

1. **Targeted** Hex: red hex
2. **Small area:** light red + red
3. **Medium Area:** Orange + light red + red
4. **Large Area:** Yellow + orange + light red + red

Line of sight

Unobstructed LoS is given if a line can be drawn from three or more corners of the attacking mech to three or more corners of the target mech.

Partial LoS is given if a line can be drawn between only two corners.

Partial LoS gives the target cover. If the obstruction is height +1, it is partial cover (+1 Dv). If the obstruction is height +2 or more, it is full cover (+2)

If the obstructing terrain is adjacent to the target, the target gains benefits of cover. (indirect weapons can be affected by partial cover rules)

If one (or fewer) lines can be drawn between different corners, the mechs do not have LoS.

Mechs cannot fully block LoS. If 2 or more LoS lines must pass through a mech, it provides partial cover to the target mech. (#3 gains partial cover from ★'s attack)

★ may attack 1 and 2 with no penalties. Mech 3 has partial cover.

4 and 6 are not in LoS of ★.

5, 7, 8 have cover from ★.

7 may attack ★ with no cover, because 7 is adjacent to the obstructing terrain.

Measuring Distance

The distance between two hexes is measured with the current hex being 0, and the target hex included in the measurement.

To determine the path of an attack, use any of the LoS lines.

Movement does not need to use the shortest path.

If two hexes are equally close to the firing line, the attacker chooses which hex to use for the path of the attack.

Playing the game

Baseline Mech stats

Mechs will have different stats, and equipment based on what mech is used, and how it was built. Here is an example Mech Sheet.

Deployment

Before the first round starts, mechs must be deployed onto the map. Roll a d10, highest value picks to deploy first or pick their deployment zone. Each player deploys one mech, alternate placing mechs until both players have placed all mechs. Whoever placed all mechs first will be the first active player.

Deployment zone is determined by the mission and map used. If no deployment zones are given, pick two opposite map edges. The deployment zones extends 2 hexes from opposite edges of the map.

Rounds, Turns, and orders.

The game is played by using orders to give mechs turns.

At the start of the round, each mech on the map makes its own order card. A destroyed mech will make a partial order card.

If there is a difference between the number of orders made between the players, the player with fewer models makes a pass card equal to the difference.

Mech order card: Gives a mech 2 Action Points and a reaction point. A mech can only use its own order card.

Partial order card: Gives a mech 1 Action Point and 1 heat. Any mech can use a partial order card.

Pass card: Makes the other player the active player. Does not change the turn number.

All cards must be used each round.

When playing order cards, place them chronologically to make a timeline, and keep track of effect durations.

Play progresses with alternating activation. The active player will use one unused card, and complete that mech's turn. Then the other player becomes the active player. This continues until all cards are used.

At the end of the round, remove the orders from the timeline, leaving any remaining effect cards.

Then, update the round number and start the next round. Alternating activation continues through rounds. (The player that went last won't be first next round)

The match continues until the end stated in the mission, or until a player has no mechs on the map.

For example, player A has 3 mechs, player B has 4 mechs. Player A goes first. A round may look like: A, B, A, B, A, B, pass, B with player A using a pass at the end. The next round may look like A, B, pass, B, A, B, A, B.

Combat

When a mech is given an order, it gains the actions and heat listed on the card. A mech can only have one reaction point at a time.

During a mech's turn, it may only complete one movement type action. A weapon may only be used once per turn.

When a mech reaches $\frac{1}{2}$ HP and $\frac{1}{4}$ HP for the first time in a match, it rolls on the threshold table. When it reaches 0 HP, the mech is destroyed.

When a mech exceeds its heat capacity, it is *overheating*.

When overheating occurs, the mech rolls on the threshold table. Overheating also causes damage equal to the heat value over the mech's heat capacity at the end of its turn.

If a mech is overheating AND reaches 0HP, it detonates.

Detonation: Centered on the destroyed mech, a small area explosion occurs, dealing damage equal to the heat value over capacity to units in range.

Falling

A mech may fall if the structure under it is destroyed, it steps off of a high elevation, or otherwise fails to fly. A mech takes an amount of damage equal to the elevation decreased * its weight class value.

For example, a medium mech steps off an elevation 1, height +3 building, and falls to elevation 1 terrain. So, it has fallen from level 4 to level 1, a difference of 3. It takes

Actions

Attacks – Each action with attack in its name is considered an attack, or is marked with a “A”. A kit may only be used once per turn.

A Weapon attack: This mech uses one weapon against another unit. Attacks require Line of Sight, and the target to be within +/-2 of the weapon’s optimal range.

For each shot characteristic, roll a d10 and add or subtract attack modifiers. The result is the Attack Value (Av)

Then compare each result to the defense value (Dv) of the target.

Multiply the weapon damage characteristic by the damage dealt multiplier.

Type	Miss	Chip	Hit	Crit 1	Crit 2	Crit 3
Av vs Dv	3+ under	1 or 2 under	Equal or over	2x over	3x over	4x over
Dmg mult	X0	1/2x	x1	2x	3x	4x

The baseline Dv of a mech is 3.

Example: Mech B has a Dv of 3...

Mech A attacks with a 2 damage weapon, rolls a 3.

Mech B takes 2 damage.

Mech A rolls a 1. Mech B takes 1 damage as Chip.

Mech A rolls a 6. Mech B takes 4 damage as Crit 1

A Slam attack: This mech uses its body to attack an adjacent mech. It has a range of 1, 1 shot, -2 accuracy, and damage equal to its weight class value. (0-4)

A Missile attack: Missile attacks do not roll to hit. This mech selects a hex within range and line of sight. The effect of the missile occurs centered on that hex. Any enemy mechs in the affected area are considered to be the target of an attack. Missiles have limited ammo; keep track of ammo remaining. A missile kit with zero ammo cannot be used.

A Program attack: Declare a target (enemy or ally) within range, and select a program to use.

Roll a d10 +/- modifiers. Compare this result to the system defense of the targeted mech.

System defense is equal to 3 + system characteristics.

Allied mechs do not gain their system characteristic as defense; a 3+ must be rolled.

A Assault attack: +1 heat per weapon used. Attack with any number of identical weapons.

▣**Barrage attack:** Double the shot characteristic of a weapon kit. +1 heat per extra shot. (*reminder: 3+ shots is -1 to hit, 5+ is -2, 7+ is -3*)

▣**Split Fire attack:** +1 heat per target. Do a weapon attack, each shot may be at a different target.

Movement – Each action below is considered movement. A mech can only perform one movement action per turn. (This restriction does not include movement reactions).

Movement actions are marked with a “→”

The full path of the Movement path must be declared, to calculate Movement cost. Movement is resolved hex by hex, in the event of any triggering effects.

Mechs cannot move into hexes that have a height change of 2 or more. Moving up a height change of 1 costs 1 extra movement. Mechs cannot move through mechs, or most other units.

Movement adds bonus evasion Dv (see Typical attack modifiers)

→ **Move:** This mech moves a number of hexes equal to its movement characteristic (Mo). Unless immovable, a mech may always move a minimum of 1 hex per move action used.

→ **Dash:** Move 1.5x of the Mo value of the mech. Gain +1 heat for each Mo added.

→ **Zig-Zag:** 2 AP. The mech moves, makes any non-move action, and moves again. The total distance moved may be up to the Mo of the mech. +4 heat. (the 1st and 2nd move paths must be declared when this action is chosen)

Other actions. The below actions are neither attacks nor movement.

Cooling: Remove 2 heat from this mech.

Hack: Some objectives or neutral structures may be controlled. The mech must be adjacent, and roll systems + d10 against the systems defense of the target. If a hacking kit is equipped, a program may be used to hack it.

Overwatch: Place an Overwatch Token on any hex within LoS of the mech. The overwatch area is a small area. an Overwatch Attack action may be made. The overwatch area lasts until the overwatch token is not in LoS. A mech may only have one overwatch area at a time.

Withdraw: 2AP. Must be on a hex at the edge of the map. Remove this mech from play.

Aim: This mech targets an enemy mech within LoS. The next attack action this mech does against the targeted mech gains a +2 to hit. This bonus is lost if the targeted mech is not in LoS at the end of any turn.

Reactions. The below actions are reactions, and require a reaction point to be used. Reactions may be done when the “If” statement occurs, regardless of whose turn it is.

Reactions are noted with a “!”

If multiple reactions would trigger at once, the reacting player reacts first, then alternate reaction activations. If a reaction would cause another reaction, resolve it first.

▣**Overwatch attack!:** If an enemy moves into this mech's overwatch area hexes, this mech may make a weapon attack against it with a +1 to hit. Remove the used overwatch area.

Brace!: If this mech is declared as a target of an attack, and before the attack is rolled. Reduce the damage dealt to this mech by ½. +1 heat on use, and +1 heat per damage reduced.

This is not an exhaustive list of actions. Mech add-ons, and objective types may add actions.

Typical Attack Modifiers

Anything described as a plus (+) value adds to the dice roll for the to-hit roll when attacking. Anything listed as a minus (-) subtracts from the dice roll.

Evasion	Moved distance	Dv Bonus
Slow	0 - 2	0
Moderate	3 - 4	1
Fast	5 - 6	2
Fastest	7+	3

Evasion: Moved Distance is calculated by the number of new hexes moved during a single action.

Weapon accuracy

Depending on the weapon, it will have a +0 to +5 on all attacking dice rolls.

Elevation

A mech gains a +1 to hit if it is 2+ height above the target.

Aim

The aim action gives a +2 to-hit for the next attack action.

Range

Attacking 2 hexes beyond or below the weapon's optimal range gives a -2 to-hit penalty.

Shots

Attacking with 3+ shots gives a -1 to hit. 5+ shots is an additional -1.

Partial Cover

Partial Cover provides +1 to the defense value of a targeted mech. Typically comes from partial LoS, +1 height terrain.

Concealed

-2 to hit if LoS must pass through a concealing hex to target. Such as from thick smoke.

Thresholds - Heat and HP

When overheating, reaching ½ HP, and at ¼ HP a mech is affected by the threshold table.

The overheating effect is temporary, until the mech is no longer overheating. Additionally, when overheating, the mech takes damage equal to the amount of heat over its capacity at the end of its turn.

HP threshold effects last until the mech is fully **restored** after the game.

If a result has no effect, re-roll. For example, an unused hardpoint, or equipment with zero ammo,

1	Disabled Hardpoint* (roll again for which equipment is disabled)
2	Disabled Hardpoint* (roll again for which equipment is disabled)
3	Disabled Jets/Legs. Any special characteristics from “Jet/Legs” equipment is ignored.
4	Disabled Pack. Any special characteristics from “Pack” equipment is ignored. If the pack has no ammo, reroll.
5	Damaged computer. Cannot make reactions, enemy program attacks gain a +1. Any “computer” equipment is ignored.
6	Damaged servos. -1 Mo characteristic, 2x heat generated from movement actions.
7	Damaged Armor: -1 Defense Value
8	Damaged radiators. Gains +1 heat per turn
9	Injured Pilot. This must be the last mech you activate each round, after pass cards are used. If this is the result while the Injured Pilot effect is active, the mech is destroyed.
10	System Reboot. This mech ends its turn, loses reaction points, does not benefit from evasion, loses its unused action card and does not generate an order next round.

Disabled hardpoint*: For each hardpoint used, randomly determine which of the used hardpoints is affected.

Weapon kit: the mech takes damage equal to the damage value of the weapon, as ammo detonates. If all hardpoints used by this weapon are disabled, it is unusable. Otherwise, this weapon has a -1 penalty to hit.

Hacking kit: Roll to determine the program, this mech is affected by that program. If any decisions are required, the enemy player makes those choices. Consumes 1 ammo of the affected type. If all hardpoints used by this weapon are disabled, it is unusable. Otherwise, this weapon has a -1 penalty to hit.

Missile kit: a random missile detonates. This missile is used, targeted on this mech’s hex. Consumes 1 ammo of the affected type. If all hardpoints used by this weapon are disabled, it is unusable. Otherwise, this weapon has a -1 maximum range.

Terrain

Each map may have unique terrain and neutral objects. These should be explained with the map. Below is a list of common terrain features.

Ground terrain like hills, cliffs, waterways change elevation, and cannot be destroyed, and are the base-level of the map.

Reminder: a mech may move up 1 elevation at +1 extra cost. Moving up 2 elevation is possible through equipment.

Elevation describes the ground level. Height is a modification of the ground level.

Hills

Gradual changes in elevation. Elevation increases by 1. Does not provide cover.

Cliffs

A sharp change in elevation. Elevation increases by 2 or more. Provides cover

Shallow water

Typically -1 elevation compared to nearby ground. Costs +1 movement.

Deep water

-2 elevation or more. +2 movement cost. Mechs in deep water are submerged, and will take 5 damage at the end of the turn.

Terrain effects are on top of ground level terrain.

Slowing material

+1 movement cost when moving into this terrain hex.

(Loose rubble, swamps, deep sand, shallow water, etc.)

Low Cover

Height +1, 5 HP. If destroyed, removed from play. Provides Cover. (Small buildings, small walls)

High Cover

Height +2, 10HP. Becomes +0 height slowing terrain if destroyed. Provides Cover. (Large concrete buildings, larger cliffs, fortifications)

Roadways

+1 movement per 2 tiles crossed (moving 3 hexes costs 2 movement) 10HP, Becomes loose terrain if destroyed.

Elevated Roadways

Height +1, +1 movement per 2 tiles crossed, 10 HP per tile. Becomes +0 height loose terrain if destroyed.
Provides Cover

Explosive depot

Height 1. Dv 2, HP 3. When destroyed, it creates a small area blast, dealing 5 damage to units in the area. Provides Cover

Vents

Produces **Concealing** thick smoke 2 hexes above this tile. (Concealed: -2 to hit if LoS must go through any amount of affected hex.)

Molten Material

2 damage and 2 heat when moving into this hex, and ending a turn on it.

Mines (advanced).

Mines cover the hex. Any mech moving into the hex takes 2 (4) damage. This hex may be Dv 2, 1 HP

Heavy Vegetation

Slowing terrain that also provides cover when adjacent or inside of. Dv 0, HP 5. Empty hex when destroyed

Static Storm

Program attacks cannot be made into or through any hex of static storm.

Neutral Units. Typically start inactive and neutral, and must be hacked to control. Units only have the actions listed.

Cannon Sentry.

Unit. Adds a 1-action order card. The sentry may activate to do a weapon attack.

Can be controlled by using an action to hack into it. Systems: 5

Weapon: 2 damage, 2 shots, range 6-10, +1 accuracy. Dv 3, 15 HP.

Designing Matches, campaigns

Non-campaign games.

Choose a credit amount to start with for both players. A small game should be 200 credits, 400 for medium, and 800 for a large game. (Remember to buy ammo!)

PLAYTEST MISSION

200 credit limit

Mission: 5 objectives evenly spread out $\frac{1}{2}$ way between the two deployment zones. Each objective is captured by hacking it (Sy Dv 3), and awards 3 VP each. The player to destroy the first enemy mech gains 2VP. Each destroyed mech is worth 1VP for every 10FP invested into it.

Campaign play.

Campaigns are the intended way to play the game. Each campaign should be designed to suit the interests of all involved players. Generally, each match should confer a large benefit to the major objective winner, with the opportunity for both players to complete objectives for credits. Credits will be used in between matches to resupply and upgrade.

Campaign special Rules

Mechs may be restored, reloaded, and upgraded between missions.

Restore: Restore 2 HP per 1 credit. Fully restoring a mech removes any HP threshold effects.

Ammo costs: missiles cost 1 credit per non-ammo MP spent. Programs cost 1 credit per non-range, non-ammo PP spent.

*Mechs start with $\frac{1}{2}$ of their ammo when the kit is made.

Frames may be **upgraded** according to normal mech design rules.

Recover a destroyed mech: A mech may be rebuilt for $\frac{1}{2}$ the cost.

Scrap: Stats may be removed from a mech. For every 3 FP removed, gain 1 credit.

Below is an example campaign.

A peace treaty will soon be signed between two warring factions. However, your pockets aren't full yet. Your mercenary group will be deployed to four last mission areas. At the end of the fourth mission, all of your assets will be liquidated as you travel off-planet. (whichever player has more total credits at the end wins!)

Starting credits: 300

Mission 1: Capture the mech factory.

Objective 1: Capture the factory by hacking an access point. (System defense 2) Each round held gives a “capture point” to that player. The factory may be captured by an opponent hacking it. First to three total rounds held, claims it.

The player who claimed the Mech Factory gains: Repairing is free (recoveries still normal cost). (Worth 400 credits at end of campaign)

Objective 2: Secure mech parts.

There are four mech part crates. A crate may be picked up by using one action while adjacent. A crate is secured if the mech ends the match with it, or extracts from the battlefield with it. Each crate is worth 100 credits.

The mission ends 3 rounds after the mech factory is captured, or only one force’s mechs occupy the battlefield.

Mission 2:

Objective 1: A Veteran Mech Pilot is looking to join-up. Be the first player to destroy an enemy mech, OR don’t be the first player to withdraw a mech.

Veteran Mech Pilot: add to any mech, increase any mech frame stat by 2. Costs to increase to that rank must still be bought, but do not count towards FP maximum.

Objective 2: Secure (destroy) warheads. Secure for money, can also be destroyed. There are 5 warheads to be captured around the map. A warhead requires 1st: a hack action vs System Defense 4, then a 2nd an action adjacent to it to load it onto the mech. The warhead is now captured, if the mech survives the fight. Each captured warhead is worth 150 credits.

Warheads may also be attacked. Dv 5, Hp 3. If a warhead is destroyed, it detonates with a small area with 3 damage and +2 heat. This also occurs if a mech holding a warhead is destroyed.

Mission 3:

Attacker/Defender. Whichever player has fewer total credits is the defender. Defender deploys first. The defender’s objective: Defend and withdraw a convoy of units. Convoy units have the following stats. 3 Move, 10Hp, Dv 3. They can only Move and Withdraw. The convoy will deploy in designated hexes, and must Withdraw from the designated hexes.

Attackers will have limited space to deploy. Attacker objective is to destroy convey units.

Each withdrawn convoy is worth 200 Credits to the defender, and a destroyed convoy is worth 100 to the attacker.

There are 4 convoy units.

Mission 4:

Secure VIPs. Each VIP is worth 100 credits, there are 15 throughout the map. VIPs are units that do not block movement, and move 1 hex towards the Bunker Structure in the middle of the map at the end of each round. Map

shows where VIPs are placed, and where each side deploys.

The bunker cannot be destroyed. The game ends when all VIPs are off the map.

Campaign end:

Add together the credit value of all mission benefits, mech parts, and unused credits. Most credits have achieved an economic victory.

Mech Stats

Each Mech has the potential to be a uniquely tailor-made machine to your personality, your opponent, and the mission type.

Every mech will have the following stats, and are modified by Frame Points (FP):

Weight maximum, W: This determines the maximum weight that can be added to the mech. It abstractly represents the total mass of the mech.

Energy maximum, E: This determines the maximum energy that equipment can use from the mech. It abstractly represents the energy produced by the generators and engines of the mech.

Hit Points, HP: The maximum damage the mech can sustain before becoming inoperable. Weight Max increases HP.

Hardpoints, Ha: Hardpoints represent areas where the major offensive equipment is placed. Each hardpoint gives 5 weapon points to make a custom weapon.

Movement, M: The overall speed of the mech, the number of hexes it can move in one action. Modified by weight class.

Systems, S: The complexity and computational ability of the mech, used for specialized equipment and hacking programs.

Derived Stats

Weight Class: based on the amount of invested FP. 0-20 FP spent is Light, class 1. 21-40 is Medium, class 2. 41-60 is Heavy, class 3. Ultralight class 0, and Super Heavy class 4 is also possible.

Heat Capacity: The amount of heat the mech can hold before overheating. Energy Max increases heat capacity. Heat capacity starts at 10.

Each weapon will have the following stats, and are modified with weapon points (WP):

Optimal Range: These values are the optimal range for the weapon, and are inclusive of the numbers listed.

Range minimum: This reduces the first number of the range band, expanding the minimum optimal range.

*Range band is the full range a weapon can be used. It is the optimal range +/- 2 hexes.

Shots: This is the number of d10s rolled per weapon attack.

Damage: This is the amount of damage each successful shot causes.

Accuracy: This is a flat bonus to all rolls made by this weapon.

Weapons may have special effects from weapon modules.

Missiles have the following stats, and are assigned to a missile kit. Missiles are modified by using missile points (MP)

Range: This is the range of hexes that may be targeted by the missile. A missile cannot be fired at a hex outside of this range.

Effect size: This is the base area size affected by the missile. Unaffected by terrain height.

Ammo: this is the number of attacks that can be done by this missile type per match.

Duration: The number of rounds the effect will last, starts at 1 round.

Each missile type will also have one or more payload effects. This effect applies to all hexes as described by the effect size.

Missiles cost Credits equal to to non-ammo MP spent when reloading between matches. A mech starts with $\frac{1}{2}$ of it ammo, the rest must be bought.

The hacking kit applies its bonus to all programs this mech can use.

Hacking Kit range: This is the range that mechs can be targeted by programs.

Hacking Programs will have the following stats, modified by spending Program Points (PP).

Ammo: This is the number of program attacks that can be made with this program.

Duration: This is the number of rounds that the program will have an effect on the target mech.

Bonus: This is the per-program to-hit bonus to apply to the program attack action.

Programs cost Credits equal to the non-ammo, non-range PP spent when reloading between matches. A mech starts with $\frac{1}{2}$ of it ammo, the rest must be bought.

Mech Designer

Building your mechs can be done many ways; here's a recommended order.

1. Think of the role of your mech.
2. Keep track of points spent, and the required weight, energy, systems, hardpoints of the mech.
3. Start with the most important parts; depending on your build. Typically, the weapons and then equipment.
4. Buy the required weight, energy, systems, hardpoints, etc. required for the desired equipment.
5. Keep it under the 60 FP limit.
6. Add any derived stats to the mech.
7. Spend credits

Building a mech starts with the frame. A frame costs 20 credits

A maximum of 60FP may be invested into a mech.

The first 20FP costs 1 credit per FP. FP 21-40 costs 2 credits. FP 41-60 costs 3 credits

Category (value)	FP range	Changes
UltraLight (0)	*Equipment	+1 Mo, ½ heat gain from movement actions
Light (1)	0-20	+1 Mo,
Medium (2)	21-40	–
Heavy (3)	41-60	-1 Mo
UltraHeavy (4)	*Equipment	-2 Mo, gain ½ heat when using BRACE

W= weight max, E= Energy max, HP= Hit Points S=system, Ha = Hardpoints.

Hit Points: 1 FP per rank, Ranks 10-30.

HP	10	12	14	16	18	20	22	24	26	28	30
(FP)	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

Weight Max: 2 FP per rank, Ranks 2-10.

W	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
(FP)	0	2	4	6	8	10	12	14	16

Each rank of weight max also adds 2 HP. (and may exceed 30HP)

Energy Max: 2 FP per rank, Ranks 2-10.

E	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
(FP)	0	2	4	6	8	10	12	14	16

Every 2 ranks of Energy Max adds 1 heat capacity

Hardpoints: 3 FP per rank, Ranks 1-6

Ha	1	2	3	4	5	6
(FP)	0	3	6	9	12	15

Movement: 3 FP per rank, Ranks 2-5

M	2	3	4	5
(FP)	0	3	6	9

Systems: 3 FP per rank, Ranks 2-8.

S	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
(FP)	0	3	6	9	12	15	18

Every 4 ranks of Systems gives +1 to-hit for weapons.

Mechs can be customized with equipment. Equipment may be taken multiple times, up to the Limit.

Kits use hardpoint slots, and are the main equipment of a mech.

Name	Cost	Limit	Effect
Weapon Kit	1W, 1E, 1-3Ha	6	Allows one weapon to be added to the mech. Each hardpoint used provides 5 weapon points for customization.
Program Kit	2E, 1-3Ha	6	Allows one programming kit to be added to the mech. Each hardpoint used provides 5 program points for customization.
Missile Kit	2W, 1-3Ha	6	Allows one missile to be added to the mech. Each hardpoint used provides 5 missile points for customization.

Packs are limited-use items. Each pack comes with **3 ammo**. Taking more of a pack only adds ammo.

Name	Cost	Limit	Effect
Jammer Pack	2E, 1Ha	2	Gain the DEPLOY 1 Jammer action. DEPLOY: Place the equipment in 1 hex adjacent to this mech. Consumes 1 ammo. [Jammer: Token. 2 Dv, 2Hp.] Systems attacks have a -2 penalty when targeting mechs within a medium area of this token.

Name	Cost	Limit	Effect
Debug Pack	3S	3	Gain the DEBUG action. DEBUG: Target self or adjacent mech. Remove one effect caused by a program. Consumes 1 ammo
Repair Pack	2W	3	Gain the REPAIR action. REPAIR: Target self or adjacent ally mech gains HP equal to 10 + 2x this mech's system value. consume 1 ammo.
Cover Pack	1W	2	Gain the DEPLOY 3 [wall] action. DEPLOY 2: place the equipment in 3 hexes within range 2 of this mech. Consumes 1 ammo. [wall: height +2, 10HP, 2Dv]
Shield Pack	2S, 1Ha	2	Gain the SHIELD! reaction. SHIELD!: After an attack is declared against this mech, but before a hit is rolled. Prevent all damage dealt this turn to this mech. Consumes 1 ammo.
Stabilizer Pack	1W, 1S	2	Gain the STABILIZE action. STABILIZE: Gain +2 to hit with weapon attacks. It has a Mo Value of 0. Using the STABILIZE action again undoes this state, and consumes 1 ammo.
Armor Pack	2W, 1Ha	2	Gain +2 Dv. Remove 1 ammo whenever this mech takes damage. (each successful shot is one instance of damage)
Booster Pack	1S, 1W	2	Spend 1 ammo to add 1 Mo to this mech until the end of the turn. May only be used once per turn.
Intercept Pack	2S, 1W	2	Gain the INTERCEPT! reaction. INTERCEPT!: if a missile attack is made on any hex within a medium area of this mech. Roll a d10 + systems vs the missile Dv of 5. On a 5+, the missile is destroyed. (In the case of multi, only one hex-target is prevented)

Relays interact with friendly mechs. All have a limit of 1, and may have multiple types.

Name	Cost	Effect
Targeting Relay	2S	Gain the SPOT! reaction. SPOT!: If this mech has unobstructed LoS to an enemy mech being targeted by an ally weapon attack, that ally gains +2 to hit.
Command Relay	2W, 2E, 2S	This mech's order may be used to activate another mech within LoS. (Any per-turn effects on either mech occur when this order is used)
Hacking Relay	2E 1S	If this mech is targetable by a friendly program attack, that attack may be used as if this mech was the targeting mech.
ICE Relay	2S	Gain the ICE! reaction. ICE!: If an adjacent mech is the target of a program attack, add this mech's system stat to the target's system Dv.

Jets and Legs modify the movement abilities. All have a limit of 1, and may have multiple types.

Name	Cost	Effect
Charge Jets	1E, 1S	Gain the → CHARGE action. → CHARGE: The mech moves up to its movement value, and then makes a slam attack. +1 heat per 1 tile moved.
Hover jets	2E, 1S	The mech hovers over the ground. Ignores ground effects. It also floats above the water, ignoring negative elevation from water tiles.

Name	Cost	Effect
Jump jet	1E, 1S	Gain the → JUMP action. → JUMP: Move, ignore ground effects between the 1st and last hex of movement, and may increase elevation by spending movement. Gain +1 heat per 1 Mo used.
Jink jets	1E, 1S	Gain the → JINK! reaction. → JINK!: After resolving an attack against this mech, this mech may move 1 hex.
ClimbingLegs	2S	This mech may move up height 2 terrain without penalty, and may move up additional height by spending 1 movement per height past 2.
Tracked Legs	2W	This mech moves even faster on paved roadways. Roadways provide +1 movement per 1 tiles crossed instead.
Flight Jets	2S, 2E	The mech must be Light or Ultralight. When using any movement action, altitude may be changed by spending movement. Movement equal to weight class is lost when using any movement action starting off the ground. Will fall if a movement action is not used (end of turn).

Computers use systems, and generally improve other actions, or have conditional passives. They are disabled by threshold effect 5 “damaged computer.” Each has a limit of 1.

Name	Cost	Effect
Assault Computer	3S	If using the assault action, Gain a +1 to hit for every 2 weapons used.
Duelist Computer	3S	If this mech and the target mech have LoS to only each other, Gain +2 on all rolls.
Melee Computer	2S	If adjacent to an enemy mech, this mech rolls an extra dice when attacking, ignoring the lowest value rolled.
Mission Computer	3S	If this mech captures or completes any objective, it gains 1 action. (an objective is anything that gives VP or credits, depending on campaign mode)
Isolation Computer	2S	If an enemy mech is within a medium area of this mech, it gains +2 Mo. It must end its turn further from enemy mechs than it started, else gain +5 heat.
Missile Computer	4S	The same missile kit may be used multiple times per turn.
Overwatch Computer	2S	This mech can have 2 overwatch areas, and gains an additional +1 to hit when using Overwatch Attack!

Passive Equipment. Other equipment that has a passive effect.

Name	Cost	Limit	Effect
Anti-Virus	2S	3	Gain +1 System Dv (multiples of this equipment stack, up to +3 Sy Dv)
Plow	2W	1	Heavy, UltraHeavy only. This mech may SLAM adjacent immobile units and structures once per turn, for no action cost.
Gapped armor	1W	3	Reduce incoming chip damage by 1, to a minimum of 1. (multiples of this equipment stack, up to -3 damage)
Liquid Cooled	1W	3	Gain +2 extra heat capacity. Remove 1 heat at the end of the turn if this mech is in water. (effects stack with rank)
Min Frame	2 Ha	1	Decrease the weight class.
Max Frame	2 Ha	1	Increase the weight class.
Air-cooled	1S, 1W	1	The mech loses heat equal to its Evasion Dv bonus at the end of its turn.
Radiator	1E, 1W	2	This mech removes 1 extra heat when using the COOLING action.
AI Pilot	3E, 1S	1	Must use the shortest possible path from start to finish hex when moving. Takes program effect PP cost if affected by an enemy program. Gain Three reactions instead of one from mech orders. Cannot be affected by threshold "Injured Pilot"
Overdrive Engine	2W, 2E, 2S	1	This mech generates an extra order per round, but has a base heat capacity of 5. If this mech is destroyed, it produces NO order cards.
Safety Protocols	1E, 1S	2	This mech rolls two dice for threshold effects, pick which result to use. (Choose after all re-rolls are done.) (4 dice if 2 ranks)

Weapon Designer

Each weapon kit can use 1-3 hardpoints

Weight	1	2	3
Energy	1	2	3
Bonus WP	1	2	3
Up to 3 weight and 3 energy may be added to the weapon’s cost, for a total of 6 weapon points, per weapon kit.			

Each hardpoint used provides 5 Weapon Points (WP)

Range: The optimal range of the weapon

Range	4-5	5-7	7-10	10-15	15-21
Cost (WP)	0	1	2	3	4

Range minimum: changes the first number of the optimal range band.

Range minum	0	-1	-2	-3	-4	-5	-6	-7	-8	-9	-10
Cost (WP)	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

The optimal range is the range minimum, and the upper range. Maximum range is +/- 2.

Shots: The number of dice rolled per attack action.

Shots	1	2	3	4	5	6
Cost (WP)	0	3	6	9	12	15

Reminder: Firing 3+ shots gives a -1 to hit. 5+ shots gives -2. 7+ shots gives -3

Damage: the amount of damage dealt per successful shot.

Damage	2	3	4	5	6	8
Cost (WP)	0	2	4	6	8	10

Accuracy: a constant to-hit bonus, added to each shot.

Accuracy	0	1	2	3	4	5
Cost (WP)	0	3	6	9	12	15

Weapons can be further customized by adding weapon modules.

Multiple modules may be equipped, but not repeated.

Damage mods.

Name	Cost	Effect
Reactor Linked	2E, 2WP	Add 1/2 of energy maximum to the damage value of this weapon. +1 heat when used.
Beam	2E, 2WP	This weapon’s damage cannot be reduced, and does not trigger reactions.
Heated	2E, 1 WP	The targeted mech gains 1 heat for every 2 damage dealt by this weapon.
Blasting	2WP	Double damage to structures. +1 damage to Heavy and UltraHeavy class units.
Precise	1S, 1WP	If the attack is a critical hit, upgrade the critical level. (Critical levels have no upper bound)
Fragmentation	1W, 2 WP	Any units adjacent to the target take ½ damage. (calculate after all damage, based on how much the original target took)

Targeting Mods.

Name	Cost	Effect
Indirect	2S, 3WP	Attacks require a clear vertical space above the target, and do not use LoS. (Partial and full cover bonus still applies)
Shredding	2WP	On a crit, the target loses 1 Dv until repaired. This effect is multiplied with the crit levels. Use the highest applied.
Zeroed	1S, 2WP	+1 to hit, can only be used in optimal range.
Core targeting	1S 2WP	+1 to hit equal to the weight class of the target. Cannot crit.
Heat Seeking	1S, 1WP	Gain +1 to hit for each 5 heat the target has.
Scoped	1S, 1WP	Ignore partial cover. Cannot be used under the optimal range.
Automatic	2WP	When making an attack action, roll an extra d10, drop the lowest result.

A weapon may be designated as Melee, and can only use the following mods.

Melee	0	The weapon may only be used on adjacent units. It may use this weapon instead of the default SLAM profile.
Name	Cost	Effect

Melee	0	The weapon may only be used on adjacent units. It may use this weapon instead of the default SLAM profile.
Jet-assist	2WP	Mech gains the → PURSUE! reaction (→ PURSUE!: An enemy mech exits an adjacent tile. This mech may use any available movement action to follow. This mech must end its reaction as close as possible.
Reactor Linked	2E, 2WP	Add 1/2 of energy maximum to the damage value of this weapon. +1 heat when used.
Heated	2E, 1WP	The targeted mech gains 1 heat for every 2 damage dealt by this weapon.
Precise	1S, 1WP	If the attack is a critical hit, upgrade the critical level. (Critical levels have no upper bound)
Blasting	2WP	Double damage to structures. +1 damage to heavy and UltraHeavy units.
Shredding	2WP	On a crit, the target loses 1 Dv until repaired or restored. This effect is multiplied with the crit levels. Use the highest applied.
Core targeting	1S 2WP	+1 to hit equal to the weight class of the target. Cannot crit.
Inertial	2WP	• damage equal to weight class value.
Rapid	3WP	• Shots equal to ½ Mo value.
Blitz	1WP, 1S	This weapon does not trigger reactions.
Parrying	1W, 2WP	+1 Dv when targeted by an adjacent mech's weapon attack

If any two weapons are the identical, it should be noted on the mech's data sheet, for use during assault attack.

Missile Designer

Missiles may be equipped if the mech has a Missile Kit. A missile kit may occupy 1-3 hardpoints, each hardpoint used provides 5 Missile Points (MP). One type of missile may be equipped per hardpoint used. When reloading, missiles cost credits equal to the non-ammo MP invested.

Weight	1	2	3
Bonus MP	1	2	3

Up to 3 weight may be added to the missile’s cost, for a total of 3 missile points, per missile type.

Range: Missiles may only target in their listed range.

Range	3-5	4-7	5-10	6-12
Cost MP	0	1	2	3

Effect Size: Use area templates

Effect Size	Target Hex	Small	Medium	Large
Cost MP	1	3	5	7

Ammo: The number of uses for this type of missile. A mech comes with ½ of its ammo, the rest must be bought

Ammo	4	6	8	10
Cost MP	0	1	2	3

Duration: Measured in rounds.

Duration	1	2	3	4
Cost MP	0	1	2	3

Payloads

Missiles may have one or more payloads.The same payload may not be taken twice per missile type.

Name	Cost MP	Description
Damaging	2/3/4	Units in the blast take 2/3/4 damage. Unaffected by duration.
Demolition	2	Deals 10 damage to structures.
Concealing	1	Affected hexes produce concealing thick smoke. (-2 to hit if LoS must go through this hex)
Hot	2	Units in the effect gain 2 heat, and at the end of their turn.

Name	Cost MP	Description
Minefield	1 / 3	Mines are a ground effect that trigger when a unit moves into the hex. it deals 2 / 4 damage. [Mine Dv 2, 1HP)
Constricting	2	Each hex in the effect is loose terrain for the duration.
Static	2	Makes a static storm on effects hexes. (prevents hacks into the hex)

Targeting Mods

Name	Cost	Description
Indirect	1MP, 2S	Attacks require a clear vertical space above the target, and do not use LoS. (Partial and full cover bonus still applies)
Multi	1MP, 1S	This missile targets a number of hexes equal to the MP spent on effect size. It does not use the area templates.
Cluster	1MP,1S	One extra identical missile may be launched, the target area must form a contiguous blast area. (hexes must touch). Hexes may overlap, but effects do not stack.

Program Designer

Programs may be equipped if the mech has a Hacking Kit. A hacking kit may occupy 1-3 hardpoints, each hardpoint used provides 5 program Points (PP). One type of program may be equipped per hardpoint used. When reloading, programs cost credits equal to the non-range, non-ammo PP invested.

Energy	1	2	3
Bonus PP	1	2	3

Up to 3 energy may be added to the program cost, for a total of 3 program points, per program type.

Program Designer

Program range: programs may only target units within this range.

Range	1-3	1- 4	1-5	1-6	1-7	1-8
Cost (PP)	0	1	2	3	4	5

Ammo: The number of uses of this program. A mech comes with ½ of its ammo, the rest must be bought

Ammo	4	6	8	10
Cost (PP)	0	2	4	6

Duration: Measured in rounds This mech does not need to stay in range for the effect to continue.

Duration	1	2	3	4	5
Cost (PP)	0	2	3	4	5

Bonus: Value added to hit/hack rolls with this program.

Bonus	0	1	2	3	4	5
Cost (PP)	0	1	2	3	4	5

Program Effects.

Each program can have one effect. Some program effects may have a different effect if used on an ally or enemy.

Name	Cost (PP)	Description
Aim assist / jam	3	The target mech gains [+/-] 2 to hit for weapon attacks
Move help / hinder	2	The target mech gains [+/-] 2 to its movement

Name	Cost (PP)	Description
Burn / Freeze	2	The target mech gains [+/-] 2 heat
Threshold Fix / Break	5	Target mech [Ignores effects of / Roll on] the threshold table
Crit [up / down]	1	[Upgrade or downgrade] critical hits made by the target mech.
Kit Theft	7	The target mech uses kit equipment with a weapon, program, or missile attack. This is a one time effect, duration does not apply.
Overclock / Lag	6	The target's next order is a Partial Order card [instead of / in addition to] the Mech Order card.
Beacon / Cloak	3	The target mech has [+/-] 1 Dv
Ping / Scramble	3	The target mech requires LoS to target / Cannot trigger reactions
Firewall / Backdoor	2	The mech has [+/-] 2 system defense against programs.
IFF scramble	3	The target mech is considered an enemy to all mechs, and cannot receive beneficial effects.

Mech sheet

Sheet explanation

Example Mech sheet

4



Reference pages

Threshold Table: Roll on when overheating, ½ HP, ¼ HP

1	Disabled Hardpoint* (roll again for which equipment is disabled)
2	Disabled Hardpoint* (roll again for which equipment is disabled)
3	Disabled Jets/Legs. Any special characteristics from “Jet/Legs” equipment is ignored.
4	Disabled Pack. Any special characteristics from “Pack” equipment is ignored. If the pack has no ammo, reroll.
5	Damaged computer. Cannot make reactions, enemy program attacks gain a +1. Any “computer” equipment is ignored.
6	Damaged servos. -1 Mo characteristic, 2x heat generated from movement actions.
7	Damaged Armor: -1 Defense Value
8	Damaged radiators. Gains +1 heat per turn
9	Injured Pilot. This must be the last mech you activate each round, after pass cards are used. If this is the result while the Injured Pilot effect is active, the mech is destroyed.
10	System Reboot. This mech ends its turn, loses reaction points, does not benefit from evasion, loses its unused action card and does not generate an order next round.

Attack Table

Type	Miss	Chip	Hit	Crit 1	Crit 2	Crit 3
Av vs Dv	3+ under	1 or 2 under	Equal or over	2x over	3x over	4x over
Dmg mult	X0	1/2x	x1	2x	3x	4x